

PARLOR PALM

Chamaedorea elegans

Made famous as a houseplant by the Victorians and placed in their parlors for exotic effect, this plant duly gained its common name, the parlor palm. The slender arching stems with a midrib dressed with opposite fanning leaves of beautiful fronds make it one of the most popular indoor palms.

“I’m resilient and will remove ammonia.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

This plant likes a spot in soft, indirect light, and the average household room temperature of 65°F (18°C) will suit it well.



POTTING

Repot the plant every other year into a container that is 1–2in (2.5–5cm) larger than the original. Use an all-purpose compost.



GROWTH RATE

These palms are slow growing, but in a few years, they can reach their ultimate indoor size of 3¼ft (1m) tall and 1¾ft (50cm) wide.



CARE

Water well in summer, but let the top soil dry out between waterings. Water less in winter. Feed monthly with a balanced liquid fertilizer.



I’ll remove toxins

I can help reduce respiratory irritation caused by exposure to airborne ammonia—a toxin released from bathroom-, surface-, and furniture-cleaning chemicals—as I absorb it into my leaves.



I have a secret

Not many people know this, but if I am well looked after and have plenty of light, as I get older I will flower, with masses of small golden globelike flowers on my multiple stems.

